Williams Combined Finishing Position

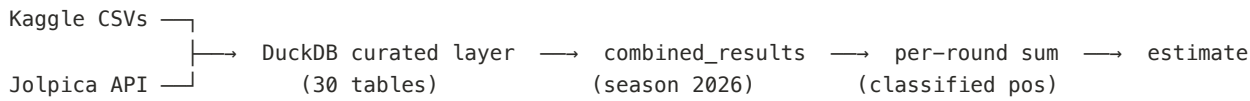
2026 Dutch Grand Prix · Zandvoort · Round 12 of 22 · Sunday 2026-08-23

31 ESTIMATED COMBINED TOTAL

range 29–33

Question	What will be the combined finishing position total for Williams Racing in the upcoming Zandvoort race?
Convention	Plain sum of the two **classified** finishing positions; lower is better (P1+P2=3, P4+P5=9)
Status	**Pre-race.** Qualifying has not run — grid position is the dominant unknown
Prepared	2026-08-21
Data source	`data/processed/f1_analytics.duckdb` — 30 tables, seasons 1950–2026
2026 coverage	Complete through round 11 (Hungary, 2026-07-26) · 176 rows Jolpica + 66 rows Kaggle

1 · Tools and method



Tools: DuckDB (embedded OLAP) · Python 3.13 + `duckdb` Python client · uv-managed env · queries run read-only against the committed database. Every number in this report is produced by one of the queries shown alongside it — nothing is hand-entered.

Counting rule. A retired or non-starting car is still *classified* and its position counts normally — no exclusion, no penalty. Two 2026 rounds turn on this: China (Albon DNS, classified P22) and Canada (Albon retired, classified P21).

VALIDATION — THE PIPELINE REPRODUCES THREE INDEPENDENTLY-SUPPLIED ANSWERS

CROSS-CHECK VS SUPPLIED MIAMI ANSWER (Q02)

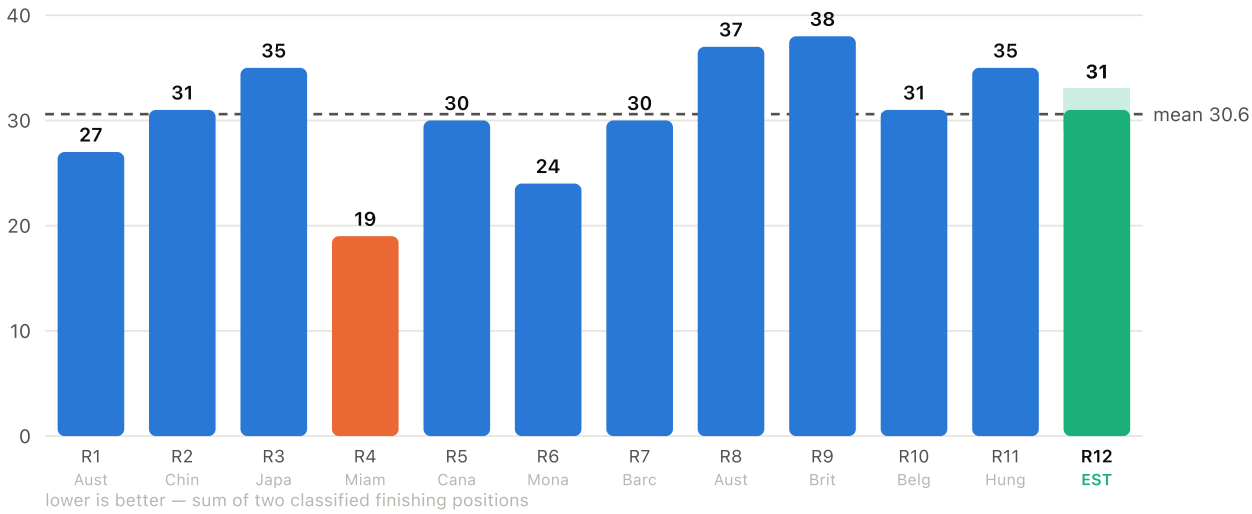
```
SELECT driver_name, position FROM combined_results
WHERE season=2026 AND round=4 AND constructor_id ILIKE '%williams%';
--  Sainz P9, Albon P10  ->  9+10 = 19   MATCHES supplied answer
```

Also verified: Canada highest Williams finish **P9**, and Melbourne fastest Williams lap **1:23.590** (Sainz) from `raw_fastf1_laps`. All three match answers supplied independently of this database.

2 · Season to date — every round

QUERY — PER-ROUND COMBINED TOTAL

```
SELECT round, race_name,
       string_agg('P' || position, ' + ' ORDER BY position) AS result,
       sum(position::INT)                                   AS combined_total
FROM combined_results
WHERE season = 2026 AND constructor_id ILIKE '%williams%'
GROUP BY round, race_name
ORDER BY round;
```



Every 2026 round. **Orange** = Miami, the season best and a clear outlier. **Green** = the Zandvoort estimate with its 29–33 range. Dashed line = season mean 30.6.

19	31	30.6	38	5.7
BEST	MEDIAN	MEAN	WORST	STD DEV

ROUND	RACE	GRID SUM	RESULT	TOTAL	NOTE
R1	Australian	36	P12 + P15	**27**	
R2	Chinese	39	P9 + P22	**31**	Did not start
R3	Japanese	33	P15 + P20	**35**	
R4	Miami	28	P9 + P10	**19**	
R5	Canadian	33	P9 + P21	**30**	Retired
R6	Monaco	23	P8 + P16	**24**	Retired
R7	Barcelona	34	P12 + P18	**30**	
R8	Austrian	35	P17 + P20	**37**	Retired
R9	British	30	P17 + P21	**38**	Retired
R10	Belgian	34	P15 + P16	**31**	
R11	Hungarian	37	P17 + P18	**35**	

THE TREND IS WORSENING

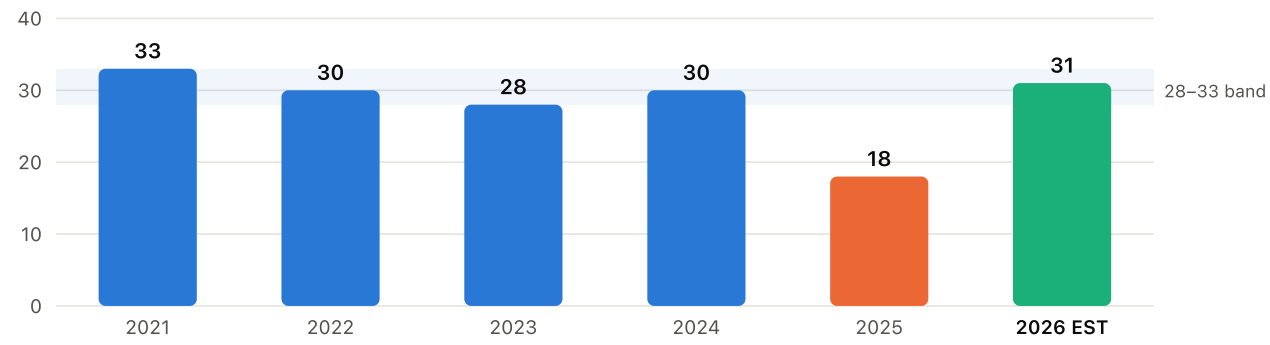
WINDOW	VALUES	MEAN
All 11 rounds	—	30.6
Last 6 (R6–R11)	24, 30, 37, 38, 31, 35	32.5
Last 4 (R8–R11)	37, 38, 31, 35	**35.2**

Nothing under 30 since Barcelona in June. Miami's 19 is an outlier, not a baseline.

3 · Zandvoort history — the tightest signal

QUERY — WILLIAMS COMBINED TOTAL AT ZANDVOORT, BY SEASON

```
SELECT cr.season, sum(cr.position::INT) AS combined_total
FROM combined_results cr
JOIN races ra ON cr.season = ra.season AND cr.round = ra.round
WHERE ra.race_name ILIKE '%dutch%'
  AND cr.constructor_id ILIKE '%williams%'
GROUP BY cr.season
ORDER BY cr.season;
```



Four of five seasons land inside the shaded 28–33 band. **Orange** = 2025, an 18 built on Albon P5 from grid 15 — the same driver pairing racing now, so relevant but optimistic.

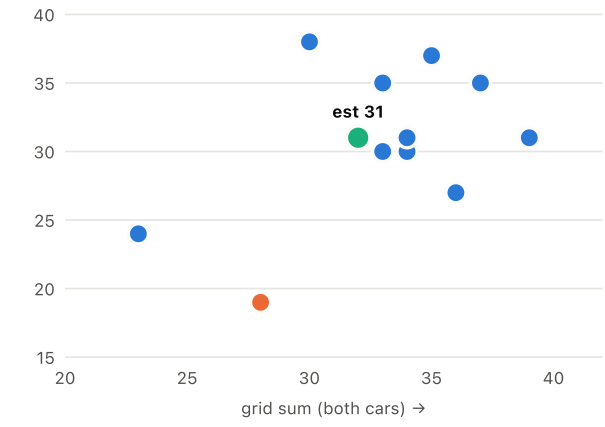
WHY THE CIRCUIT COMPRESSES OUTCOMES

QUERY — GRID-TO-FINISH VOLATILITY, ALL TEAMS

```
SELECT cr.grid, cr.position
FROM combined_results cr
JOIN races ra ON cr.season=ra.season AND
cr.round=ra.round
WHERE ra.race_name ILIKE '%dutch%'
  AND cr.season >= 2021 AND cr.grid > 0;
-- median |finish − grid| = 3 places
```

Zandvoort 2021–25, **97 starts**: median position change **3 places** (mean 3.6). Only **30 of 97 (31%)** moved 5 or more places. Low overtaking caps the upside *and* the disasters.

GRID POSITION DRIVES THE TOTAL



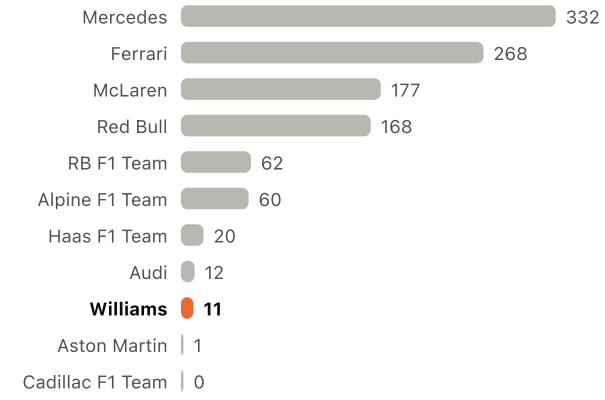
Each dot is a 2026 round. Better grid → better total, loosely. The estimate assumes a typical grid sum near 32.

4 · Competitive context

QUERY — CONSTRUCTOR STANDINGS AFTER R11

```
SELECT standing_rank, constructor,
cumulative_points
FROM combined_constructor_standings_by_round
WHERE season = 2026 AND round = 11
ORDER BY standing_rank;
```

Williams sit **P9 of 11** on **11 points**. Mean grid 16.5 across the season, drifting to **17.0** over the last four rounds. This is a slow car being asked to finish well.



2026 constructor points after round 11. Williams highlighted.

5 · How the estimate resolves to 31

PULLS WORSE (33–35)	PULLS BETTER (28–30)
Last 4 rounds average 35.2	Zandvoort clusters 28–33 across five seasons
P9 of 11 constructors, 11 points	Median position change only 3 places
Qualifying drifted 16.5 → 17.0	Low overtaking caps disaster scenarios
DNF or DNS in 5 of 11 rounds	2025 Zandvoort was 18 with this same pairing

31 is where the two forces meet — simultaneously the season median (31), inside the Zandvoort band, and a modest concession to poor current form.

REVISE ONCE QUALIFYING LANDS

IF WILLIAMS QUALIFY	THEN ESTIMATE
Both cars in the top 12	26–28
Grid sum near 32 (typical)	**31**
Both cars 17th or worse again	34–36

6 · Caveats

- **Qualifying has not run.** Grid position is the dominant input and it is currently unknown.
- **Retirement risk is real but already priced in.** Williams have had a DNF or DNS in 5 of 11 rounds; a single retirement costs roughly 6–8 on the total. Those rounds are included in the mean, not excluded from it.
- **This is a pre-race estimate, not a computed answer.** It will be reconciled against the source-backed result once round 12 data lands.

Generated 2026-08-21 from `data/processed/f1_analytics.duckdb` · catalog entry `catalog/intake/2026-08-21-zandvoort-combined-finish.yaml` · all figures reproducible via the queries shown above.